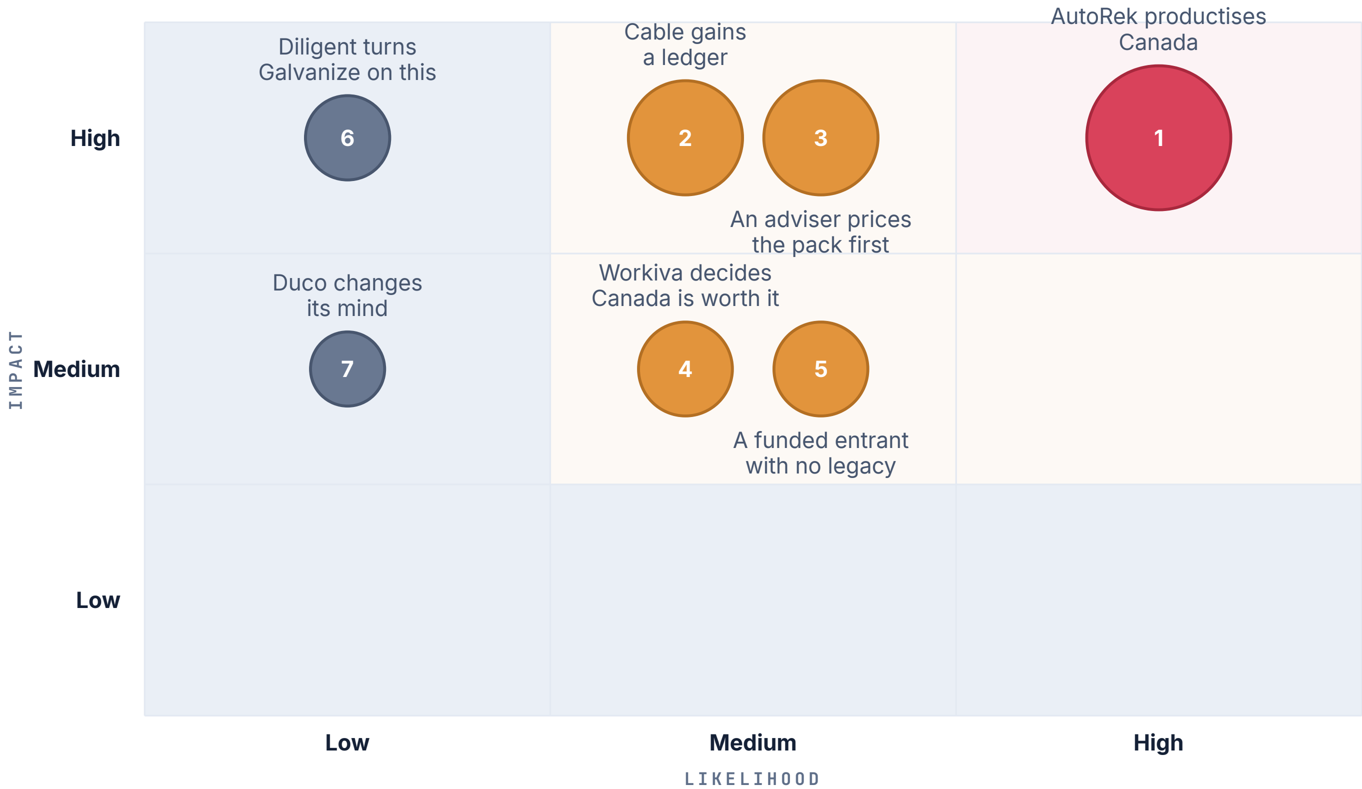
DOMAIN 02 · SEVEN SCENARIOS · RE-RUN QUARTERLY. EVERY FINDING HERE HAS A SHELF LIFE

Competitive Risk

Who else could reach this buyer, what would each of them have to build first, and how long is the window actually open?

Twenty three products were read on their own published material on 16 and 17 August 2026. The market splits in two and the split is the case: every vendor with a real Canadian presence sells money laundering monitoring or data plumbing and never sees end user funds, and every vendor that computes a daily position on money held for customers is British. **None of the twenty three carries SOR/2023-229, none proves a record has gone unaltered, and none rebuilds history it was not connected for.**



Bubble size is the risk score, likelihood 1 to 3 multiplied by impact 1 to 3. The number inside is the scenario row in the table overleaf.

High 7 to 9 · Medium 4 to 6 · Low 1 to 3

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

The assessed set	Twenty three products across reconciliation engines, evidence platforms, retention and archive, money laundering and identity, ledger infrastructure and control testing. 4orm Finance Comparables and Benchmarks, 17 August 2026 · 4orm Finance Service and Price Comparison, 17 August 2026	MODEL
The five gaps	0 of 23 carry the Canadian duty, 0 prove a record unaltered, 0 reconstruct history, 4 compare held against owed and all four are British, 6 have a Canadian presence and none touches end user funds. 4orm Finance Comparables and Benchmarks, 17 August 2026	MODEL
Scoring	Likelihood and impact are management judgements on a 1 to 3 scale, set against the threat ranking in 4orm Finance Comparables and Benchmarks, 17 August 2026.	MODEL

The seven scenarios, scored

#	Scenario and trigger	L	I	Score	Early warning signal
1	**AutoRek productises Canada without announcing it** It already computes a daily position on money held for customers, calculates the shortfall, tracks breaches and generates regulatory returns, with the Bank of England and Lloyds as named users, and it already writes Canada on its coverage line with no Canadian regulatory content behind it	3	3	9	A Bank of Canada module, a Canadian rule pack or a North American sales presence appears on its own site
2	**Cable, inside Synctera, gains a safeguarding ledger** Synctera acquired Cable in April 2026 and runs a Canadian platform with a Canadian sponsor bank. Cable produces evidence an outside party can be pointed at, including read only access for a reviewer. It holds no funds position at all	2	3	6	Cable or Synctera material references the payments act, SOR/2023-229 or the Bank of Canada, or Cable's use cases stop being framed on United States regulations
3	**A Canadian adviser puts a fixed price on the annual report pack first** The market is served by advisers today and not one publishes a price. Putting a fixed fee on a 31 March filing pack needs no software, and the review and annual report line carries $10,346,903 in 2031	2	3	6	Any Canadian retail payments adviser publishes a fixed fee for a safeguarding review, a framework or an annual report pack
4	**Workiva decides a few hundred Canadian registrants justify content** 6,750 customers, US$236M of subscription revenue in a quarter, named Canadian financial institutions, and linked data that carries a change record from source to disclosure. It has neither bank ingestion nor a reconciliation engine	2	2	4	A Canadian payments or safeguarding entry appears in its published solution list, or it announces bank or ledger connectivity
5	**A funded Canadian entrant starts with no legacy to carry** An eleven month old regime with a public register of named buyers and no incumbent attracts capital. A purpose built entrant would start where this company starts, with more money	2	2	4	A Canadian regtech seed or series A announcement framed on payments supervision, safeguarding or retail payments evidence
6	**Diligent turns Galvanize on payments safeguarding** It owns Vancouver based Galvanize, whose heritage is analytics across whole transaction populations, which is close to this work. It discounts less than any peer in the set, which reads as a company defending a premium	1	3	3	Galvanize marketing moves from internal audit toward funds held for customers, or Diligent prices below its board portal band
7	**Duco changes its mind about client money** 155 people, EUR 35M of revenue, Nordic Capital behind it, a New York office and Scotiabank as a named client. It publishes on payment provider reconciliation and has declined to build a client money module even at home, where the deadline has already passed	1	2	2	A client money or safeguarding module appears in its product list, in any market

Legend. Likelihood and impact each run 1 to 3 and the score is their product. Every early warning signal in this table can be checked on the vendor's own website, which is the reason the ranking is worth re-running every quarter rather than once.

1 AutoRek productises Canada without announcing it

SCORE 9 · L3 × I3

CASE STUDY · VANTA, AND HOW FAST A FUNDED PLATFORM CLOSES A GAP ONCE IT DECIDES TO

Vanta crossed US$300M of annual recurring revenue by April 2026, roughly five years after entering its market, and reported 16,000 or more organisations on the platform (Business Wire; Vanta). It got there by adding frameworks and moving upmarket, and where a capability was missing it bought rather than built. The useful figure is not the revenue. It is the five years, against a Canadian window this plan measures in quarters.

> RESPONSE FOR 4ORM
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> AutoRek is the one name to watch every quarter, and the check is its own website. It has the hardest part built already: a daily computation of money held for customers, a shortfall calculation, breach tracking and regulatory return generation, with the Bank of England and Lloyds as named users. It has already written Canada onto its coverage line with nothing Canadian behind it. What it lacks is a rule layer, the Bank of Canada report formats, a reviewer facing pack and a North American sales presence, and that is localisation on an existing engine rather than new architecture. **The answer is not to race it to a rule pack, because that race goes to the larger cheque.** It is to hold contracts it cannot answer: three signed enterprise tier customers and one completed outside review that used the evidence pack. Those two retire the pricing objection and the product objection, and nothing else retires either.

2 Cable, inside Synctera, gains a safeguarding ledger

SCORE 6 · L2 × I3

CASE STUDY · A PLATFORM THAT NEEDED A TRUST CENTRE BOUGHT ONE

When Vanta wanted a capability it did not have, it acquired it rather than building it, and shipped the result inside every plan: a trust centre with 5,000 or more hosted pages, which its customers use to deflect 87 per cent of inbound security reviews (Vanta; what a trust centre is). A group that already owns the distribution treats a missing module as a purchase order rather than a roadmap.

> RESPONSE FOR 4ORM
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> Synctera and Cable are the shortest path on the board. The group already has the two things this company does not: a live Canadian platform with a Canadian sponsor bank, and capital. Cable's entire pitch is producing evidence an outside party can be pointed at, including read only access for a reviewer, which maps directly onto the outside review the rules require. What it lacks is the ledger. Cable tests controls and holds no funds position of any kind, and its use cases are still framed on United States regulations. **That is one real build sitting next to the right shape of engine, which is why the score is what it is.** The move is the one Plaid made with the banks rather than the one it made first: treat the sponsor bank relationship as a channel and open the conversation before the group decides Canadian payment providers are a segment rather than an accident. Lock the reviewer relationships and the design partners while the ledger gap is still open, because switching cost has to exist before the group arrives, not after.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

AutoRek's own material	Daily client money computation, shortfall calculation, breach tracking and regulatory return generation, with the Bank of England and Lloyds named. Coverage line includes Canada with no Canadian regulatory content. safeguarding · banking as a service	PRIMARY
Vanta	Crossing US$300M of annual recurring revenue, April 2026 · the first years, in its own account	SECONDARY
What retires the objection	Three signed enterprise tier contracts and one completed outside review using the evidence pack, both before the seed is priced. 4orm Finance Comparables and Benchmarks, 17 August 2026, section 7.	MODEL

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

The acquisition	Synctera acquired Cable in April 2026, joining an auditor facing control testing engine to a live Canadian platform with a Canadian sponsor bank. Business Wire	PRIMARY
What Cable sells	Cable · use cases framed on United States Regulations B, E and Z. It holds no funds position.	PRIMARY
Vanta's trust centre	the product · 5,000 or more hosted pages, 87 per cent deflection	PRIMARY

3 A Canadian adviser puts a fixed price on the annual report pack first

SCORE 6 · L2 × I3

CASE STUDY · XERO, AND WHAT A MANDATE DOES THROUGH AN ACCOUNTANT

Xero's United Kingdom revenue and customer numbers each grew 51 per cent in the half year after Making Tax Digital for value added tax took effect, and it attributed the outcome to the mandate together with the partner channel, the brand and the marketing behind it (Accountancy Daily). The channel was the mechanism: free partner subscriptions, ledger tools and directory presence, so the accountant reached the business before any software vendor did (Xero partner programme). The same shape appears in this category, where more than 80 per cent of Drata's customers connect with an auditor through the platform and Vanta runs more than 100 audit firms across 26,000 or more audits (Drata; Vanta).

> RESPONSE FOR 4ORM
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> This is the threat with the lowest barrier in the whole matrix and the one least likely to be seen coming, because it does not require software. Every Canadian retail payments adviser checked prices by scoping call and none publishes a rate for a review, a remediation or an examination response. Putting a fixed fee on a 31 March filing pack is a pricing decision, not a build, and the line it competes with carries $10,346,903 in 2031 and $21,618,107 across the plan. **The counter is to make the adviser the channel before one of them becomes the competitor.** The plan already routes about half of new business through partners by 2031, at a ten per cent margin, with independent reviewers deliberately excluded from that margin because a reviewer taking a cut of a subscription has a financial interest in what they review. Publish the evidence pack format, give reviewers the workspace free, and let the adviser bill their own fee on top of it. An adviser earning on this company's record does not build a competing one.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Canadian advisers	All three sell services and none publishes a price. Platino Consulting · AML Incubator · Outlier Compliance Group	PRIMARY
Xero and the accountant channel	51 per cent growth after the mandate · the partner programme	SECONDARY
Reviewer channels elsewhere	Drata, more than 80 per cent connect with an auditor · Vanta, 100 or more audit firms	PRIMARY
The channel in the plan	Partner origination rising from 20 per cent in 2027 to 51.6 per cent in 2031 at a ten per cent margin, with reviewers excluded. Line D at $10,346,903 in 2031. 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full	MODEL

4 Workiva decides a few hundred Canadian registrants justify content

SCORE 4 · L2 × I2

CASE STUDY · WORKIVA'S OWN CURVE, AND THE ECONOMICS THAT MAKE CANADA AWKWARD FOR IT

Workiva is the cleanest precedent for selling into a population a regulator has named and counted. It reached 1,421 customers, which was 13.9 per cent of the 10,229 filers required to submit in a structured format, in year one, and 20.6 per cent by year three (Workiva). Today it carries 6,750 customers with 2,690 above US$100,000 a year and 276 above US$500,000, on US$236M of subscription revenue in a quarter (investor releases; contract value bands). It has also reported deal cycles lengthening after a filing deadline passes (earnings call). A book that size does not bend toward a few hundred registrants easily.

RESPONSE FOR 4ORM

The capability is closer than the count suggests. Workiva already carries named Canadian financial institutions and already propagates linked data from source to disclosure with a change record, which is one half of what this product does. What it does not have is bank and ledger ingestion, and without both it cannot compute a position on money held for customers. **The obstacle is the economics rather than the capability, and economics change faster than engineering does.** The watch is its published solution list rather than its balance sheet: a Canadian payments entry, or any announcement of bank or ledger connectivity, is the signal. The defence is the same one that answers the whole evidence platform half of the set. Not one of the twelve platforms assessed connects to a bank account, and not one connects to a customer funds ledger. Both connections have to exist before a daily comparison can be made at all, and that is a different product rather than a feature.

5 A funded Canadian entrant starts with no legacy to carry

SCORE 4 · L2 × I2

CASE STUDY · STEELEYE, AND WHAT CAPITAL ALONE BUYS IN A MANDATED MARKET

SteelEye launched a cloud compliance platform for the second European markets directive with roughly 30 clients against 9,000 or more firms in scope, and reached about 0.33 per cent of that population (Traders Magazine; SteelEye). It was early, it was funded, and it was aimed at a dated obligation with a named population, which is exactly the setup here. Being first with money did not convert. What converted elsewhere was the professional in front of the buyer.

RESPONSE FOR 4ORM

An eleven month old regime with a public register of named buyers and no incumbent is visible to anybody who looks, and a purpose built entrant would start where this company starts with a larger cheque. The counter is not to out raise them. It is to be further along the two things capital does not buy quickly. The first is the archive: a record becomes more valuable because it existed on the day the event happened, and a customer who has been running since 2027 cannot be given that history by a vendor arriving in 2029. The second is the reviewer relationship, which is a named channel of about 120 firms sitting in front of dozens of obligated businesses each. **Both compound with time and neither can be bought in a quarter.** The honest part of this scenario is that both are unproven today: no reviewer has yet used the pack in a live engagement, and that is the single structural condition the core market does not meet.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Workiva	13.9 per cent of 10,229 filers in year one, 20.6 per cent by year three · 6,750 customers and US$236M of quarterly subscription revenue · customers above US$100,000 and US$500,000 · deal cycles after a deadline	PRIMARY / SECONDARY
The evidence platform gap	None of the twelve evidence platforms assessed connects to a bank account, and none connects to a customer funds ledger. 4orm Finance Comparables and Benchmarks, 17 August 2026	MODEL

6 Diligent turns Galvanize on payments safeguarding

SCORE 3 · L1 × I3

CASE STUDY · ADJACENCY IS NOT ENTRY, IN THIS MARKET OR THE ONES BESIDE IT

Canadian vertical software shows how far an adjacent product can sit from a duty it appears to touch. Clio sells trust account management to Canadian law firms and Lone Wolf and NexOne serve real estate back office and trust accounts (Clio; Lone Wolf; NexOne). All three are practice management systems rather than an evidence layer, and none of them carries a payments rule pack. Meanwhile the legal software market shows how slowly an incumbent converts an installed base: a migration pathway offered to 15,000 firms leaving a legacy product, and a well regarded competitor holding about 0.17 per cent of its own category (Legal Technology; Actionstep).

> RESPONSE FOR 4ORM
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> Diligent is the one with people in Canada. It owns Vancouver based Galvanize, whose heritage is analytics across whole transaction populations, and that is close to this work. Two decisions stand between the capability and the market. It would have to point Galvanize at money held for customers rather than at internal audit, and it would have to accept a contract value below its board portal band. It discounts less than any peer in the assessed set, which reads as a company defending a premium franchise rather than one chasing a niche. **Likelihood is low and impact is high, which makes this a watch rather than a work item.** Track Galvanize's marketing language and its pricing floor, and treat any move below the board portal band as the signal that the calculation has changed.

7 Duco changes its mind about client money

SCORE 2 · L1 × I2

CASE STUDY · A COMPANY THAT HAS ALREADY DECLINED THIS MARKET TWICE

Duco has the engine and has said no with its roadmap rather than with a press release. It runs 155 people on EUR 35M of revenue with Nordic Capital behind it, keeps a New York office and names Scotiabank as a client. It publishes commentary on payment provider reconciliation and has not built a client money module, including in its home market, where the equivalent deadline has already passed. Two chances, two declines. That is a preference rather than an oversight.

> RESPONSE FOR 4ORM
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> Monitored, not feared, and the honest reason is that the reverse could happen at any time. The mitigation that actually holds across all seven scenarios is the one the comparables document states plainly: the people who could take this market are pointed elsewhere and have been for years. Kani raised a series A and aimed it at the United States. AuditBoard's declared international expansion was Germany and Drata's was Europe. Vanta's framework catalogue holds no Canadian entry of any kind. Duco has published on this and built nothing. **None of that is permanent and none of it is a defence. It is a window, and it should be carried in a room as a window.** The thing that converts a window into a position is a signed Canadian customer on a record a reviewer has accepted, which is why the response to every scenario on this board ends at the same two milestones.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

SteelEye	Launch with roughly 30 clients against 9,000 or more in scope firms · the raise behind it	SECONDARY
The reviewer channel	About 120 independent reviewers, class management estimate, no published roster. They owe no trust duty of their own and sit in front of dozens of firms that do. 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full, population register tab.	MODEL
What is not yet proven	No reviewer has used the evidence pack in a live engagement. Milestone 15 sets that at Q2 2028. 4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full, milestones tab.	MODEL

What to watch, and how often

Every line below is checkable on somebody else's published material, which is what makes this domain worth re-reading on a schedule rather than once. None of it requires a subscription, an analyst or an introduction. The quarterly pass is one person, one morning, and seven websites, and it is the cheapest control in the whole bundle.

Monitoring cadence

- **AutoRek's own website, every quarter.** A Bank of Canada module, a Canadian rule pack, a reviewer facing pack or a disclosed North American sales presence. This is the highest scoring scenario in the domain and the check costs nothing.
- **Cable and Synctera material, every quarter.** Any reference to the payments act, SOR/2023-229 or the Bank of Canada, and any move away from framing use cases on United States regulations. Treat the sponsor bank as a channel conversation to open rather than a threat to answer.
- **Every Canadian retail payments adviser, monthly.** Watch for the first published fixed fee for a review, a framework or an annual report pack. This is the cheapest threat to launch and the one with no product signal in front of it.
- **Workiva's published solution list.** A Canadian payments entry, or any announcement of bank or ledger connectivity, changes the economics argument.
- **Canadian regtech funding announcements.** Any seed or series A framed on payments supervision, safeguarding or retail payments evidence.
- **Galvanize marketing and Diligent's pricing floor.** A move below the board portal contract band is the signal that the calculation has changed.
- **Duco's product list, in any market.** A client money or safeguarding module anywhere means the engine has been pointed at this work.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Canadian advisers	All three sell services and none publishes a price. Platino Consulting · AML Incubator · Outlier Compliance Group	PRIMARY
Workiva, Diligent, Duco	Workiva investor releases · contract value bands. Diligent's Galvanize heritage, its discount position, and Duco's headcount, revenue, office and named client all from 4orm Finance Comparables and Benchmarks, 17 August 2026, sections 4 and 6.	PRIMARY / MODEL

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Canadian vertical software	Clio trust account management · Lone Wolf back office · NexOne accounting	PRIMARY
Incumbent conversion	A migration pathway offered to 15,000 firms · Actionstep at about 0.17 per cent	SECONDARY
Diligent and Duco	Galvanize heritage, the discount position across the peer set, and Duco's 155 people, EUR 35M revenue, New York office and named client. 4orm Finance Comparables and Benchmarks, 17 August 2026, sections 4 and 6.	MODEL
Where the others are pointed	Kani to the United States, AuditBoard to Germany, Drata to Europe, no Canadian entry in Vanta's catalogue. 4orm Finance Comparables and Benchmarks, 17 August 2026, section 5.	MODEL

Two contracts retire this entire board, and no argument retires any of it.

Three signed Canadian customers at the enterprise tier retire the pricing objection. One completed outside review that used the evidence pack retires the product objection. Until those exist, every figure on this document is a position held by argument, and the four things that cannot be added to the record later are the only real head start: the store that is only added to, the two dates on every record, rules held as writing, and customers kept apart at the key.

1 What the window is

- No vendor holds a Canadian safeguarding customer today, so there is no incumbent to displace and no reference to be measured against.
- The four British specialists reach the United Kingdom and Europe. None has opened a third jurisdiction.
- An evidence platform would have to build a ledger before a Canadian rule badge means anything.

2 What the window is not

- It is available for a defined period rather than forever, and the period is nobody's to set.
- Adding a rule to a framework library is a week of work, so the rule is never the moat.
- Two vendors in the set use the word immutable. One describes no mechanism and the other means bookkeeping that is only added to.

What retires the objection	How many	By when
Signed Canadian contracts at the enterprise tier	3	Before the seed is priced
A completed outside review that used the evidence pack	1	Before the seed is priced
A named second rule maker customer, to switch Line E on	1	Before Line E is quoted
A published partner or white label comparable	1	Before that tier is quoted

Legend. Each row is a defect in the evidence rather than in the plan. Until a row is satisfied, the figure it supports is presented with the gap named beside it. Line E carries $13,766,769 in 2031 and the partner tier has no published comparable in any market.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

The window, stated as a window	4orm Finance Comparables and Benchmarks, 17 August 2026, section 5, the mitigation and what would have to be true for it to be wrong.	MODEL
The four things	4orm Finance Technical Architecture 03.2, 17 August 2026, the four things that have to be right in the first release and what adding each one later costs.	MODEL
Every figure on this document	4orm Finance master pro forma rebuild of 16 August 2026, base case, recalculated in full. 4orm Finance Master Source Register, 16 August 2026. Vendor material read on 16 and 17 August 2026.	MODEL